

THE FALL OF BABYLON.

BABYLON, "the beauty of the Chaldees' excellency," after all its other power has long ceased, still retains the power of attracting an unfailling interest on account of the extremes of its history in its ancient greatness and its present desolation. The restoration of "The Golden City," with its hundred gates of solid brass, with its walls three hundred and fifty feet in height and more than eighty in breadth, with its temple and tower of Belus, with its magnificent palace and marvellous gardens, was designed by Alexander the Great; but the attempt was suddenly arrested by his death, and its desolate site has for long ages been the habitation of the "wild beast of the desert, and of doleful creatures." To the Christian community, the chief interest in the extreme contrast of the past and the present lies in the prophecies that foretold the doom of Babylon as the great enemy of Israel, and the grand centre of ancient heathenism with its idolatry, sensuality, and cruelty.

These prophecies have been received and valued by the Jewish nation and the Christian Church as amongst the greatest predictions in the Hebrew Scriptures, and the most remarkable attestations to the truth of the Word of the Lord, which endureth for ever; and their well-known authors, living in Jerusalem, have been honoured as bearing the highest names among the Hebrew pro-